



1-25-26
make often
add 1/2 cup mini chips
to batter &
sprinkle some on top
W

ultimate banana bread

SERVINGS: 8 TO 10 **TIME:** 75 MINUTES **SOURCE:** SMITTEN KITCHEN

Very key here is the size of your loaf pan because this will fill out every speck of it before it is done. Mine holds 6 liquid cups; it's 8×4 inches on the bottom and 9×5 inches on the top. If yours is even slightly smaller or you're nervous, go ahead and scoop out a little to make a muffin or two on the side. When making this for the first time, place a sheet pan underneath, just in case it spills over but I can promise you that in several tests, mine never has.

1/2 cup (4 ounces or 115 grams) unsalted butter, cut into chunks, plus more for pan

1 cup (190 grams) packed light brown sugar

2 slightly heaped cups (about 18 ounces or 510 grams) (updated weight, see why) of mashed banana, from 4 extra-large or 5 medium-large bananas

2 large eggs

1 teaspoon (5 ml) vanilla extract

1 teaspoon fine sea or table salt

1 heaped teaspoon ground cinnamon

A few gratings of fresh nutmeg (optional)

1 teaspoon baking soda

1 teaspoon baking powder

2 cups (260 grams) all-purpose flour

1/2 cup mini chips

2 tablespoons (25 grams) raw or turbinado sugar (on top)

Heat oven to 350 degrees F. Butter a 6-cup (9×5-inch) loaf pan (see note up top if yours is smaller) or coat it with a nonstick cooking spray and set aside.

Melt butter in a large bowl and whisk in brown sugar until smooth, then stir in mashed banana.

Whisk in eggs and vanilla. Sprinkle the surface of the batter evenly with salt, cinnamon, nutmeg (if using), baking soda, and baking powder, and whisk until the ingredients are fully dispersed in the batter, and then whisk 10 more times around the bowl because it's better to be overly cautious than to end up with unmixed pockets. Add flour and stir until combined. *add mini-chips*
Scrape batter into prepared loaf pan. It should come to just over 1/2-inch from the top rim. Sprinkle the top of the batter with the raw sugar; it will seem like a lot but will bake up beautifully. *and a handful of mini chips*

Bake banana bread for 55 to 65 minutes. It is done when a toothpick or skewer inserted into the bread is batter-free — be sure to check the upper third as well, near the rim of the pan; that's where I'd find the unbaked pockets of batter hanging out. The bread will get very dark but will not taste burnt.

Let cool in pan. This banana bread is good on the first day but exceptional on the second and third, if you can bear to wait.

To store: Leave the banana bread in the pan, uncovered. Once cut, press a piece of foil against the cut side of the remaining loaf but leave the top uncovered — you worked hard for that crunchy top and should not sacrifice it to humidity. It keeps for five days at room temperature, possibly a week in the fridge, but it vanishes in two to three days, max, so you, like us, might never find out.



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